# Meridian Tech Employee Handbook (fictional)

## 1. Working Hours and Remote Work

Core hours at Meridian Tech are 10:30 to 16:30 IST, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours employees may arrange their own schedule with their team lead.

After completing the 90-day probation, employees may work remotely up to three days per week. During probation, remote work is limited to one day per week.

Remote employees must reply on the team chat within 30 minutes during core hours. Remote workers receive an internet allowance of Rs 1,200 per month, paid with salary.

The office is closed on the second Saturday of every month and on the 14 public holidays listed in the annual calendar.

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## 2. Leave Policy

Full-time employees accrue 24 days of paid leave per year, at two days per month. Up to 10 unused days can be carried forward into the next calendar year; the rest lapse.

Sick leave is 12 days per year. A medical certificate is required when the absence is longer than two consecutive days.

Parental leave is 26 weeks for the primary caregiver and 2 weeks for the secondary caregiver. Bereavement leave is 5 days for the death of an immediate family member.

Leave of more than three days must be requested at least 5 working days in advance through the HR portal.

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## 3. Expenses and Travel

Expense claims must be submitted within 30 days of the expense, with original receipts attached. Late claims are rejected unless the finance team approves an exception.

Meals during business travel are reimbursed up to Rs 1,500 per day. Flights must be economy class for journeys under 6 hours.

Hotel stays are reimbursed up to Rs 6,500 per night in metro cities and Rs 4,500 per night elsewhere. Any single claim above Rs 25,000 needs approval from a director.

Approved claims are paid with the next payroll cycle, usually by the 7th of the month. Each employee also has a learning budget of Rs 30,000 per year for courses and books.

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## 4. Performance and Conduct

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in April and October, using a rating scale from 1 to 5. A rating of 4 or higher makes an employee eligible for the annual bonus pool.

The standard notice period is 60 days; during probation it is 30 days.

Harassment complaints go to the Internal Committee, which acknowledges every complaint within 48 hours and concludes its inquiry within 90 days.

Gifts from clients or vendors worth more than Rs 3,000 must be declared to the compliance officer.